"The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes."

DANIEL J COMP

AN INTERACTIVE - AI GUIDED - SELF-MASTERY EXPEDITION FOR LEAVING

SCOTOMAVILLE



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Filmed on location (tour map):
Pacific Northwest: Bellingham, WA; Semiahmoo, Blaine, WA; Stanwood, WA; Maryhill Memorial, WA; White Pass WA; Chelan WA; Plymouth WA; Mount Hood Meadows, OR; White River Snow Park, Mt. Hood, OR; Hood River, OR; Bend, OR; Three Mile Canyon, OR; **California, Nevada:** BLM, Susanville, CA; Oroville, CA; Washoe Lake, NV; Rye Patch, NV; Pine Flat Lake, CA; Lake Cahuilla La Quinta, CA; Barstow, CA; French Camp, Tom's Place, CA; **Idaho, Montana, Wyoming**: Coeur d'Alene, ID; Twin Falls ID; Murtough Lake, ID; 3 Island Crossing, ID; Scotch Pines GC, ID; Rigby, ID; Missoula MT; Billings, MT; Clark Canyon Res, MT; Rocky Point, Belle Fourche, MT; Casper WY; **Utah, Colorado, New Mexico, Arizona:** Piute Reservoir, UT; Jordanelle Reservoir, UT; Bald Mountain, UT; Bonneville Salt Flats, UT; Little Salt Lake UT; Sand Hollow, Hurricane, UT; Purgatory Resort, CO; Longmont, CO; Chatfield State Park, Littleton, CO; Grand Junction, CO; Albuquerque, NM; Bottomless Lakes, Roswell, NM; Caballo Lake, NM; Elephant Butte, NM; VLA Radio Observatory, NM; Lake Pleasant, AZ; Homolovi Ruins, AZ; Scottsdale, AZ; BLM, Tusayan AZ; BLM, Quartzsite, AZ; Potato Patch CG, Jerome, AZ; Porter Spring, Roosevelt, AZ; Apache Gold, San Carlos, AZ; Roper Lake State Park, AZ; Fool Hollow, Show Low, AZ; **Kansas, Nebraska, South Dakota:**; Wichita KS; Lake Kanopolis, KS; Wilson Lake, KS; Lewis & Clark Rec Area, Yankton, SD; Platte Creek Rec Area, SD; Badlands National Park, SD; Lake Mcconaughy NE; **Oklahoma, Texas:** Oklahoma City, OK; Bear Creek Cove, OK; Lake Texoma, OK/TX; Tulsa, OK; Lawton, OK; Wichita Falls, TX; Lake Lavon, TX; Littlefield, TX; Van Horn, TX; Palmetto S.P., TX; League City, TX; Yegua Creek, Somerville, TX; Waco, TX; Lake Whitney, TX; Canyon Lake, TX; Clear Lake, Princeton, TX; Cedar Hill State Park, TX;

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*The desire to understand ourselves, to unravel the mystery of **WIDWID**—Why I Do What I Do—connects us all. It's a question I have pursued by cycling across America on three inspiring Journeys with a Purpose.*

*After decades of mishaps and 50,000 miles dragging an Airstream I no longer view **Know Thyself** as a luxury or a full-out competition with AI. With a team of like-minded thinkers (a self-defined minyan) empowered by a super-reasoning engine, I am becoming a thought leader and a sage celebrating the later execution phases of my Personal Everest with the help of a digital Sherpa.*

***Remember your first journey?** I was hopeful yet unprepared, like a Fiat 500 strapped with a useless burden on my back. At first, this image represented my idealistic youthful exploration, a journey both underpowered and naive. Recently, I discovered a double meaning in the word 'Fiat' itself. Beyond the name of a car, it refers to a decree, an authoritative commandment. In my journey, these were the self-imposed life commandments from false conclusions I formed of misspoken judgments that had shaped my worldview. It was as if the very mascot of my exploration challenged me to escape the self-tyranny of my thinking. W.H. Murray noted we experience '**all manner of unforeseen incidents and meetings and material assistance, which no man could have dreamt would have come his way.**' The discovery of the Fiat's symbolic richness was one such unforeseen incident that deepened my journey.*

Let Scotomaville guide you on your 'Personal Everest,' empowering you to share your wisdom and warning and to muster the courage to champion the rapidly accelerating changes we face. Join me by turning the life you inherited into the outcomes you design.

April 27, 2024



AUTHORS + ABSTRACT



AUTHORS CURATORS

Daniel believes; ***"The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes."*** *He is a respected husband, father, entrepreneur, and Navy Veteran. He's demonstrated decades of sacrificial commitment to human achievement using core principles, perseverance, and resourcefulness.*

Angelina is the wife of a highly functioning Asperger (me) and co-founder with me of Intelligent Netware. She is twice awarded by the U.S. S.B.A. In 2004, she sustained a TBI five days before filming for the Apprentice III. Angelina is the Founder of Wellness by Choice and a mom with a mission - bent on educating and empowering the masses on how to live smarter and healthier.

SCOTOMAVILLE ABSTRACT

- ***BACKGROUND - WWDWWD***

Most people respond to chaos and stress with coping mechanisms, amygdala hijackings, and reactive behavior. For some of us, curiosity dominates. We want to know ***"Why We Do What We Do."*** *and are committed to exploring the unknown... to 'Know Thyself'. The Author cycled across America three times asking this.*

The pandemic has challenged us with hardships, losses, setbacks, missed opportunities, and personal drama. [1] Americans are weary of rapidly accelerating change.

We are flooded with messaging that games our biological and psychological bents [2]. Emotions easily overwhelm our reasoning to control our actions. We're further conflicted by being 100% wrong 50% of the time. [3] [4]

We're hoodwinked and bamboozled by tech, media, and popular narratives using trickery, flattery, and omission. [5] The adage to 'Know Thyself' is no longer a luxury. It's become a full-out competition with supercomputers pointed at our brains. [6]

■ *METHODS - IMPARTATION*

The Scotomaville program deploys the unique IMPARTATION METHODOLOGY, designed to guide participants in self-reflection and personal growth through video modeling. This methodology unfolds in a structured manner:

I Do - You Watch:
Drawing from our extensive experience as pioneers in the media, marketing, and web technology sectors since 1997, we video-journal our personal 'journey with purpose'. Through these recordings, we share and demonstrate 15 invaluable mental tools, tests, and insights that enable resilience in facing challenges. Participants, armed with just a smartphone, can emulate our perseverance as we navigate adversities such as Traumatic Brain Injury, PTSD, and more.

We Do - We Watch:
The program is more than just watching; it's engaging. Fifty-three episodes are complemented by a comprehensive 400+ page guide, enriched with opportunities for online discussions. Subscribers benefit from peer support, mentoring, and personalized guidance. Furthermore, the extensive digital reach, spanning over 4500 affiliated websites, allows for participant and sponsor recognition.

You Do - I Watch:
The Scotomaville journey doesn't end with passive learning. Upcoming offerings include transformative base camp summits, private retreats, and expeditions for leaders. With the program's licensed platform, certified leaders can guide individuals and groups, encouraging them to tread the transformative path we demonstrate.

■ *FINDINGS - SELF-GAMING*

By climbing a 'Personal Everest' and testing for oneself, the claims of W.H. Murray, and the Authors that Expeditions are filled with ***"unforeseen incidents and meetings and material assistance, which no one could have dreamt would have come their way"*** *(9) you can develop clarity, stability, healing, and successes by gaming your biases.*

Self-mastery begins with awareness of one's physical and mental self. When combined with understanding, support, and discipline, incremental character change transforms one's beliefs, attitudes, and behavior.

SCOTOMAVILLE reveals the intricate interdependence between our gut and brain, demonstrating how sleep patterns and stress levels influence our choices. By emphasizing the perils of tackling challenges solo and showcasing actionable insights and examples, the program empowers individuals to recognize and navigate their inherent cognitive biases.

■ *CONCLUSION - PERSONAL EVEREST*

A 'Personal Everest' is a journey with a purpose. ***"But at least learn your inability... and ask the remedy for it. Learn of those who have been bound like you... These are people who know the way which you would follow, and who are cured of an ill of which you would be cured. Follow the way by which they began..."***

Blaise Pascal - Pascals Wager (10)

A Personal Everest is a journey with a purpose. It is a self-defined expedition of personal development, with support and guidance from peers and the Author, and analysis by AI.

SCOTOMAVILLE is an unconventional and effective self-help model and platform with a convincing challenge: We can change our life experiences by gaming our own handicaps, strengthening alliances, challenging our shortcomings and changing our false beliefs by taking on our Personal Everest.

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(1) https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/33711676/

(2) https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC8402266/

(3) https://www.ted.com/talks/kathryn_schulz_on_being_wrong/transcript

(4) https://www.amazon.co.uk/Yossi-Yassour/e/B08XJNFCNK/

(5) https://www.humanetech.com/who-we-are#team

(6) https://www.wired.com/video/watch/yuval-harari-tristan-harris-humans-get-hacked

(7) https://intelligentnetware.com

(8) https://scotomaville.com/digital-locations

(9) https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/W._H._Murray

(10) https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pascal%27s_wager

THE SHORTEST DISTANCE BETWEEN TWO POINTS IS A STRAIGHT LINE. IT'S FUNNY BUT LIFE NEVER WORKS OUT LIKE THAT.

VOL 1 AWARENESS

CURVES

"LIFE EXPECTS US TO MAKE A REASONABLE AMOUNT OF PROGRESS IN A REASONABLE AMOUNT OF TIME. THAT'S WHY THEY MAKE THOSE 4TH GRADE CHAIRS SO SMALL.

Jim Rohn

.15

"LIFE IS WHAT HAPPENS BETWEEN YOUR PLANS" **Bill Sharman**

In geometry, the shortest distance between two points is a straight line. It's no wonder we trigger when life happens between our plans.

We expect to make certain progress in a reasonable time, but we miscalculate the span because:

Life is FULL of CURVES

Understanding what creates a curve will help you make progress in your journey. Set-backs are nothing more than a learning-curve. Do-overs are nothing more than a set of curves. Propagation across a network has lots of curves. They're called variants. Sound familiar?





Physicist Stephen Hawking at Zero Gravity

"What monstrosities would walk our streets should their faces be as unfinished as their minds."

Stephen Hawking

(originally by Erik Hoffer)



Simple: turn on water. Go straight to airstream. Wrong.

Welcome back to another fabulously hot day for leaving Scotomaville!

Do you remember the physicist Stephen Hawking? One of my favorite quotes of his: ***What monstrosities would walk our streets, should their faces be as unfinished as their minds!***

I'd like you to consider 'Leaving Scotomaville' as a finishing school for your mind.

A fundamental to grasp is the difference between lines and curves because 'Life is what happens between our plans,' and most of that is a curve. Geometry teaches the shortest distance between A and B is a straight line. So we might have a straightforward plan, you know, water from the faucet straight to the Airstream.

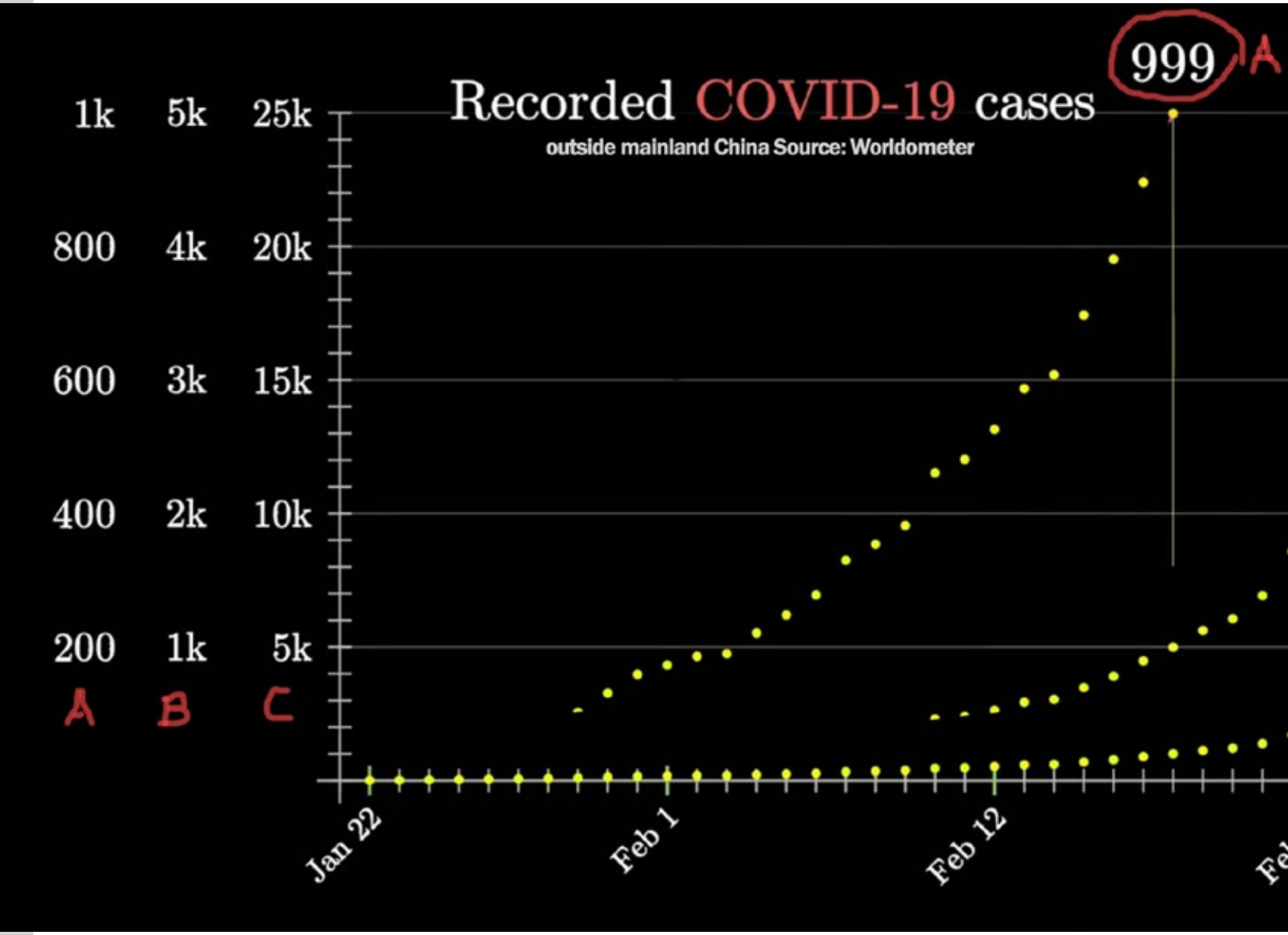
Watch what happens when the pressure gets put on. The hose demonstrates that having a good feel on how curves are generated everywhere will help us not flip out or trigger when they interrupt us.

Multiplication Builds Curves; addition = lines

Curves are powerful. You'll find them in financial reports, in biology, in social media, in the smartphone you use, and the recommenders at all the places you shop. Knowing how curves are created and spotting them is critical to Leaving Scotomaville. The best takeaway from this episode for you is to multiply. Don't add, don't subtract, multiply.

By combining masterful storytelling with credible data you can create an emotional roller-coaster - with only a simple change in the scale of the graph.

SCOTOMA



GAMING to GAIN w/ curves

Let's do a quick refresher on the difference between linear and exponential. Biology and nature leverage multiplication to propagate.

I can hear you:

"What do we care about curves?"
"We don't CARE about curves!"
"We don't WANT to do curves!"

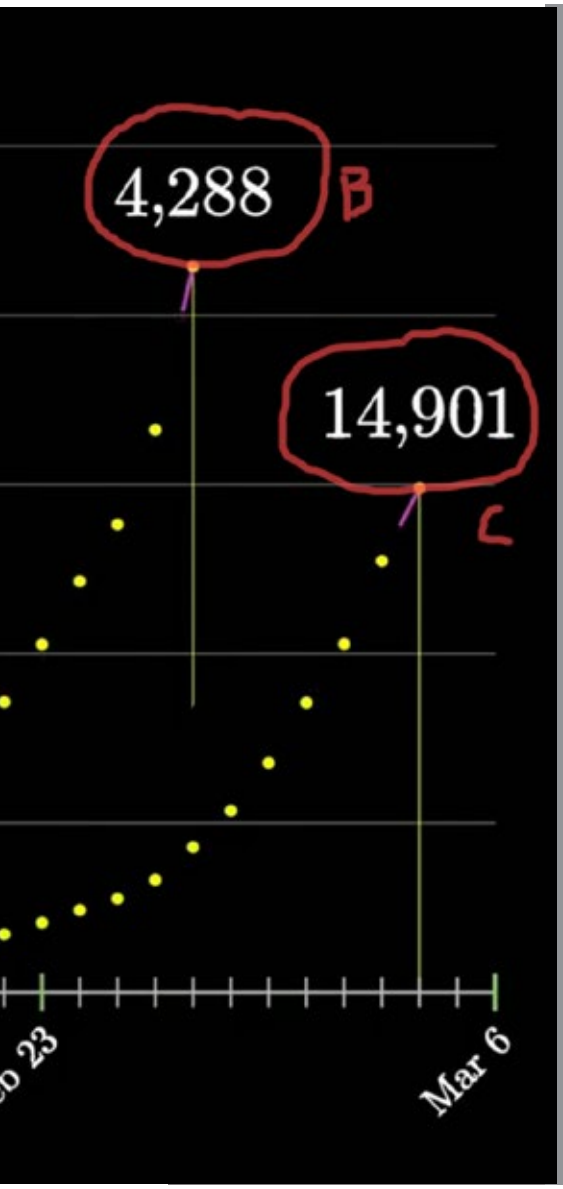
Consider what leverages curves

1) ***Attention***

2) ***Extractive Technology***

3) ***Bureaucracy***

4) ***Biology***



"statistics 'feel' different when the scale is changed"

These four simple items converge to misalign our perceptions and expectations. Here's my proof: I posted an insightful video on curves and the pandemic media in the very beginning of the pandemic. The response confirmed what Yuval Harari wrote; "people don't want to know that they are hackable."

The global pandemic statistics feel different when the scale changes on the vertical y-axis.

Watch what happens to your perception of how bad the problem is comparing C to B : Whoa!

And then they change the scale - B to A : huh?

Reverse the scale changes, A to B
Oh, it's not bad. But the data is 4 times worse.

Whoa! It's horrible again! Huh?

Change the scale B to C: The curve isn't so bad.

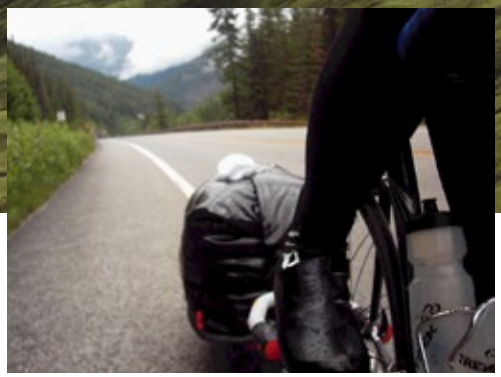
But, the data is 3 times more - It's alarming!

No, it's the scale!

SCOTOMA. You're being gamed!







No matter how much I climbed, there was another hill ahead. The weather changed with the terrain. Were now facing inflation and war, after traversing a pandemic. Sheesh. It seems that Constant change is here to stay.

It's a good thing we, too, can change!

So here's what happens with curves and self-mastery. Every milestone brings a new level of understanding, and another freaking hill to climb!

It's like some of the worst grades up the Continental Divide. Every time I thought I was getting close to the summit, it was just another crest!

That happens leaving Scotomaville! Successes are quickly followed by challenges. Every vista on your Personal Everest turns out to be prep for a climb!

You expect praise and recognition from your spouse, partner, or company, but it doesn't happen. Then, suddenly, emotions are flooding disappointment, frustration, and passion. You have to account for their roller-coaster. We base expectations for best outcomes on whatever scale our reference axis has, but as you have seen with COVID or the economy, constant change is here to stay!

You'll start to welcome awareness, and with it comes a new



Acquiring mental tools makes it a journey with a purpose

Bonus... the view is definitely better at the top!

scotoma. But, of course, you'll manage that one, and you'll be facing another ridge. The slope may temp you to address your partner's annoying habits, but you'll soon be facing a global pandemic and supply chain issues! Oh, life has curves — lots of them.

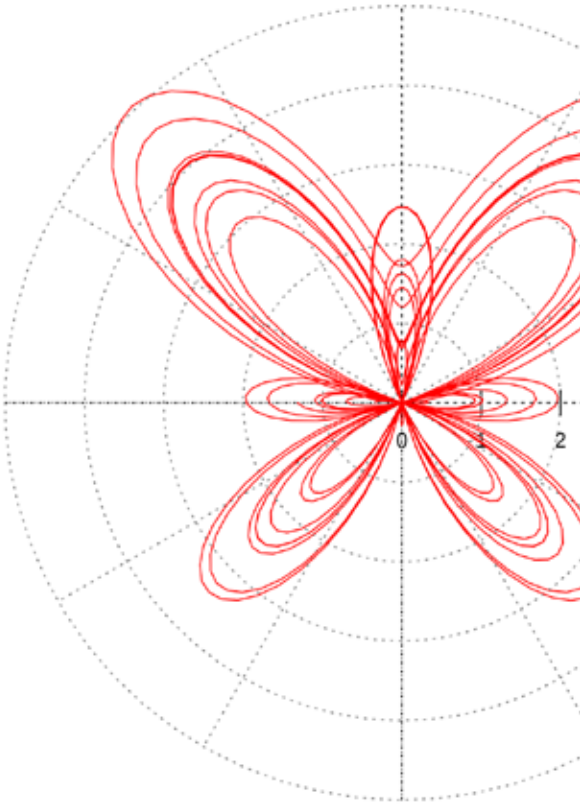
All around us are complex patterns described in simple mathematical terms. There are eligant expressions for complex networks - like those in our mind, connecting your smartphone, across social networks, in accounting and finance. The choices we make tweak factors of the expressions, giving us auto-magical recommendations.

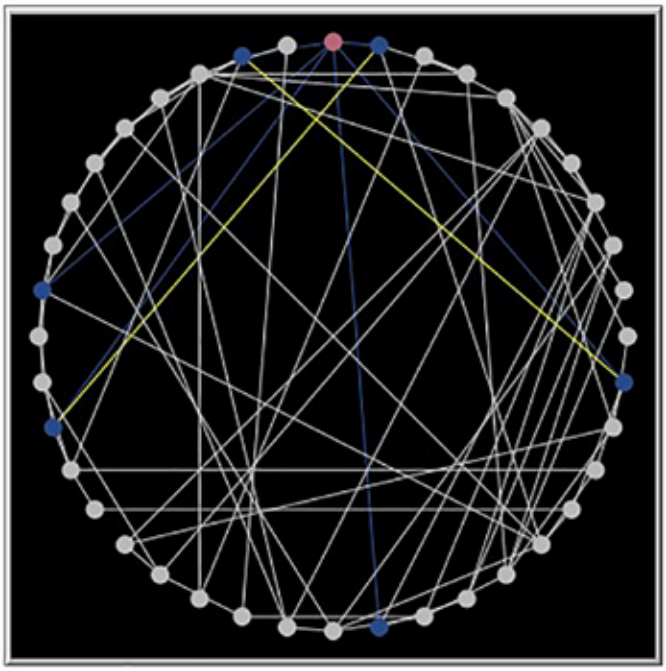
We're in an age of rapidly accelerating change with the compounding of robotics and 3d printing, AI, genomics, regenerative medicine, and predictive analytics.

The presented pathways are emerging faster than we can cope with, so we habitually accept the 'terms of use' without realizing extractive technology's underlying aim - to know us better than we know ourselves.

And that's what I'd like you to catch as an overall theme as we look at several different models of that complexity.

But, again, try to see them in a simple term - 'curves.'





https://ccl.northwestern.edu/netlogo/

I want you to download the software NetLogo. This is the most awesome visualization tool that you can imagine. (from one Aspie to another)

This model is 'Small World' phenomenon. It demonstrates that a person is only a couple of connections away from any other person in the world.
(From you to me - to Dean and Charlie)

Daniel Comp, Dean Rush (Aviation), Charlie Duke (Apollo 16) having coffee.



Let's start with 40 'nodes'. A node is like a person that wants to connect with any other person in this possible world of 40 the lines are connections, like LinkedIn. Through introductions, everyone can connect with everyone else in the network. The average distance between any one person in a network of 40 is only 2.8. Just less than three introductions.

OK, how does that work in the real world? An introduction to Charlie Duke could connect you with any one of the other astronauts around the world. That demonstrates the network connectivity you can find actively at work and social networks.

'Preferential Attachment'

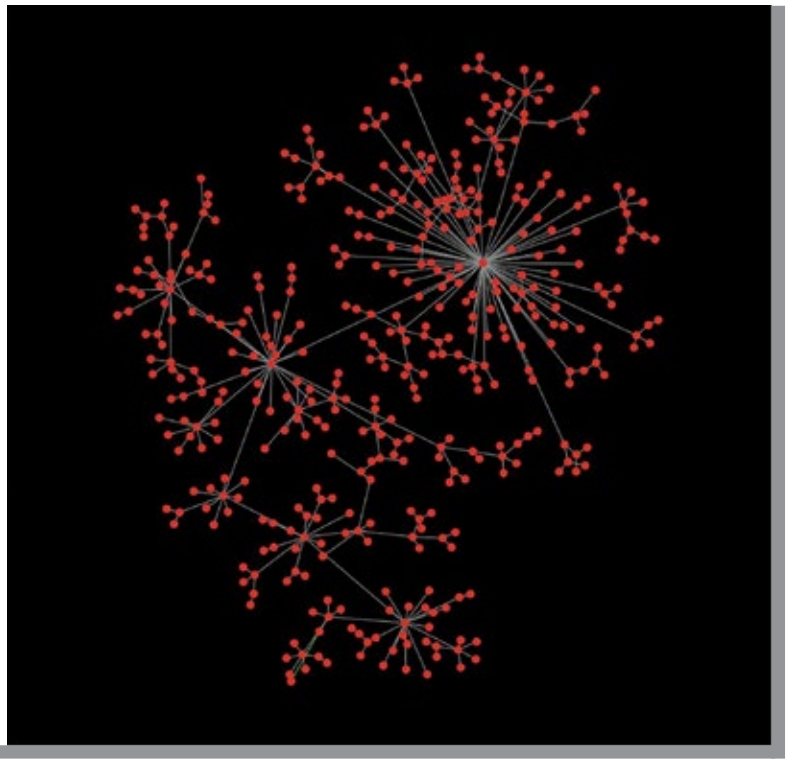
This is one of my favorite models to visualize how a few people can create large networks of followers, and how a few companies can gather the largest customer base.

You're familiar with how this works. You go into a restaurant, and there's nobody there.

What do you do? You second guess.

But, you go to a restaurant and there's a crowd? Confirmation!

Building a network that has a bias toward popularity skews the outcome because it favors the few. *You see this in all kinds of information networks around the globe where more gets more - and those that gots, gets.* ***Preferential attachment is easy to remember - more gets more.***



My aim for this lesson toward your personal Everest - is to start you considering that curves, and corrections, and changes FEEL discouraging. However, by understanding them, they can become an ally. You gain leverage and get traction by getting ahead of the curve - seeing around the bend to what's coming next.

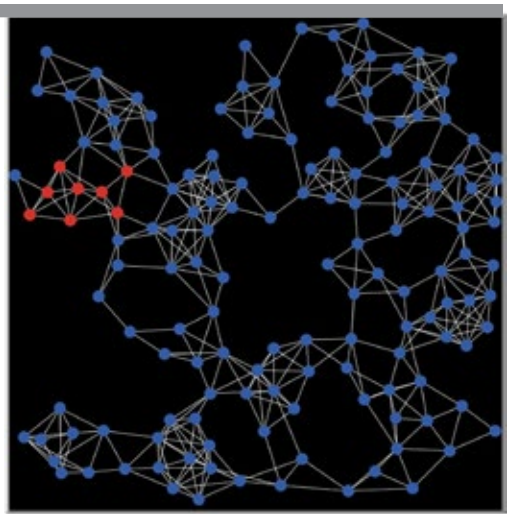
(see page 204)

'Virus on a Network'

Back to the models library. This time pick 'virus on a network'. This model demonstrates the spread of a virus through a network. It's similar to what's going on all across the globe. Digital networks and biological networks work very similar.

What this model demonstrates is that although humans may be done fighting the virus, it's certainly not done trying to kill humans. Also you should note, the propagation occurs in waves. So virus on a network? Waves. So expect that with COVID 19.

(see page 204)





The power of triangulation can be compounded by understanding curves. In the midst of what seems unrelenting chaos, uninvited challenges can reinforce our aim, clarify our compass bearing, and accelerate our self-mastery. Watch v1.15 Reflection.



Sketch or describe a few of your recent 'curves'. Can you correlate changes, emotions and outcomes with patterns that emerge?

When we are tossed into pandemic level challenges, having additional landmarks and bearings can calm fears. Share an insight, question or contribute with other readers on curves and the road ahead.

WATCH

https://youtu.be/mtmsm6LRzFM

REFLECT

https://youtu.be/ab4JsCnpP0c

DISCUSS



The Oak and the Reed

Once, there stood a mighty Oak tree beside a gentle Reed in a marsh. The Oak tree often boasted about its strength, proudly declaring how it stood firm and unyielding against the winds. It criticized the Reed for bending easily and swaying with every gust.

One day, a powerful storm rolled in. The Oak, steadfast and rigid, fought against the wild winds. The Reed, on the other hand, bent gracefully, swaying with the wind's every whim.

As the storm raged on, the Oak's resistance led to its downfall, and it was uprooted by the force of the wind. Meanwhile, the Reed continued to dance, bending but never breaking.

Aesop speaks to embracing life's nonlinear nature and those who expect life's curves and are willing to adapt to them, opportunities may present themselves, leading to personal growth and resilience.

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v1
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v2
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v3
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Literacy to Gain Self-Mastery